Gene The most basic unit of heredity; part of a DNA molecule that transmits characteristics from a parent to its offspring.

Genome The complete set of an organism's genes.

Geology The scientific study of Earth's physical formation and structure. Geologists examine our planet's history and the ongoing processes that are acting upon it.

Global warming A gradual increase in the temperature of Earth's atmosphere that is caused by the accumulation of greenhouse gases.

GMO Genetically Modified Organism—any life form that has been artificially and chemically altered by engineering techniques that modify its DNA.

Greenhouse effect The way in which gases in Earth's atmosphere trap heat. The buildup of these gases leads to global warming.

Greenhouse gas Gases such as carbon dioxide and methane that absorb energy reflected by Earth's surface, stopping it from escaping into space.

Green Movement A political ideology that encourages a greater focus on the importance of the environment, and asks people to take action to prevent damage to Earth's natural habitats.

Groundwater Water found below Earth's surface, such as in spaces in the soil, sand, or rock.

Habitat The area in which an organism naturally lives.

Herbivore An organism that eats only plants.

Homeostasis The regulation of conditions within an organism, such as temperature, water, and carbon dioxide, to maintain a stable internal state.

Hypothesis An idea or assumption, used as the starting point for a theory, which is then tested through scientific experimentation.

Inheritance The passing on of genetic qualities and behavioral predispositions to offspring, through both genetic information and parental